Jerald Sheets

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WORK EXPERIENCE

LinkedIn

SpaceXai **Dec. 2025 - Present**
Sr. Linux Systems Engineer - IT Systems
Remote

- Manage systems with Puppet Enterprise and the OpenVox Project (VoxPupuli's continuation of Puppet Community); write code, tests, and CI/CD deployment.

mechanisms and architect automation for worldwide deployment of SpaceXai Infrastructure.

- Build and maintain complex applications on Linux systems, for SpaceXai working groups.
- Develop and maintain Standard Operating Procedures, compliance, and audit.

Oak Ridge National Laboratory **Mar. 2023 – Nov. 2025**
Sr. Linux Systems Administrator - Puppet Automation
Remote

- Maintain ORNL Digital Active Archive (DAAC) system for NASA run projects.
  Archive and present biogeochemical data to NASA, NOAA, and other governmental entities
- Straight Systems Architecture and Administration, automation with Puppet Community (now continued as OpenVox by VoxPupuli).
  Manage and maintain highly available environment of RHEL-based data systems for government
- Develop documentation, best practices and training materials, and lead a team of 4 engineers.

Penacity, LLC **Mar. 2022 – Mar. 2023**
Sr. Automation Solutions Architect
Remote Contract

Perform architectural design and implementation of Puppet Enterprise in on-premises and AWS environments both for U.S. Government clients and the corporate office. Act as SME for all Puppet Configuration Management tools and methods, Automation, CI/CD, and development in regard to Puppet.

- As the Puppet SME, I worked closely with the USDA staff and management to implement new environments, develop new installation modules, and to maintain operational efficiency of the Automation Environment
  - Performed Puppet upgrades, development, and training to increase customer engagement and abilities
  - Worked with USDA team to troubleshoot and implement new environments automated with Puppet.

PayPal, Inc. **Aug. 2016 – Mar 2022**
Sr. Continuous Security Strategist - Puppet Automation
Remote

- Lead and manage Information Security automation initiatives with Puppet Configuration Management tools and methods.
  - Built Continuous Security CI/CD Pipeline DevOps workflows with Jenkins, Puppet, Docker, and GitHub
  - Automate entire provisioning framework with Puppet from "Golden Image" to production.
- Cloud Technologies - Automate key PayPal security processes in AWS and Google Cloud, delivering containerized and traditional architectures.

Shadow-Soft **Jan. 2014 – Aug. 2016**
Sr. Puppet and Solutions Architect
Remote/Traveling Consultant

- Nationwide Travel Consultant implementing Puppet Enterprise for corporate customers as a Puppet Labs Partner Consulting Engineer
- Conference Speaking, Social Media Presence, and blogging on behalf of the Puppet ecosystem for Shadow-Soft

- Lead team of 4 consultants, train and equip for Puppet Labs engagements nationwide

Accelarad/Nuance **July 2013 – Jan. 2014**
Sr. Linux Systems Architect
Atlanta, GA, Remote
- Main Linux Systems Architect for entire Accelarad fleet. Team leader and implementation specialist for Radiology SAAS Solution.

Apple, Inc **July 2011 - July 2013**
Sr. UNIX Systems Engineer
Maiden, NC
- Systems Architecture, Engineering, and Administration for all Apple Stores worldwide. Performed New Store Openings, trained staff, and organized entire "go live" for in-store POS servers and equipment

Incomm, Inc. **Nov. 2010 - July 2011**
Sr. Linux Systems Administrator - Contract
Atlanta, GA
- Systems Administrator for prepaid card industry leader. Inventory management, provisioning (kickstart) and holiday 24-hour observability rotation.

Intercontinental Hotels Group **Aug. 2010 - Oct. 2010**
Sr. Technology Consultant
Atlanta, GA
- Staff augmentation for various expansion projects and engineering needs. Build Asset Inventory system, procure hardware and network equipment and bring RedHat systems within hardening compliance guidelines.

CNN News Systems **Oct. 2008 - Aug. 2010**
Sr. Systems Engineer
Atlanta, GA
- Responsible for CNN video library and Tape archival system. Sun StorageTek SL 8500 systems, Sun Solaris, RedHat Linux, and data center management.
- Upgrade of entire serving infrastructure, decommission old hardware, and excess old equipment
- Manage and maintain RedHat Linux platform machines, program in Perl and BASH, and support development teams and leadership.

EDUCATION

Evangel University **Current**
Master of Arts - Theological Studies *Springfield, MO*

St. Stephen's University **Mar. 2008 - Apr. 2016**
Bachelor of Arts - Christian Studies - Graduated *St. Stephen, NB CA*

Louisiana State University **Aug. 1985-Dec. 1988, Jun. 1995 - May. 1996**
Bachelor of Science - Music Education - 60 Hours *Baton Rouge, LA*

CERTIFICATIONS, SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Certifications:** *Puppet Certified Professional (2014, 2018, 2019) * RHCE/RHCSA/RHSH (2014) * Telcordia PRO-INS*
- **Technologies:** *DevOps, Consulting, Linux/UNIX, AWS, GCP, Puppet Enterprise, OpenVox, VoxPupuli, Git, RSPEC, Serverspec, BASH, Perl*

- **Skills Team** *Leadership, Automation, Infrastructure Development, Training, Documentation, Presenting, Speaking*
- **Interests:** *HAM Radio (KO4JIL), Music, Open-Source Contribution, Hiking, Training, Public Speaking*
- **Writing:** Author: "Scaling Puppet Community", "Kickstarting Linux Client Installs", "Making Open Webmail Work", Technical Reviewer: "Puppet 8 for DevOps Engineers"